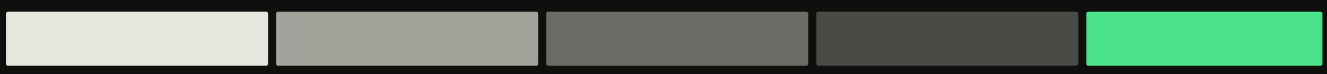
koverr

FREE KIT · 6 PAGES · TRACE IT, CUT IT OFF

How did they get your number? Trace it. Cut it off.

The four ways a phone number escapes, how to work out which one was yours, the settings that cut the calls, and a ready-to-send letter that makes a company tell you where it got your details.



Time
15 minutes

Checked
12 November 2026

Includes
Access-request letter

STEP 1 · TRACE IT

Your number got out one of four ways.

The clue is usually in what the caller or text already knows. Match it to a row.

PATH	HOW IT HAPPENS	THE CLUE	HOW TO CHECK
Stolen SCAM TEXTS	A company you used was breached and your number was in the data. It is now on lists that scammers trade.	Texts naming a real company you use: a delivery firm, your bank, a shop.	Search your email at haveibeenpwned.com and read which breaches included phone numbers.
Sold SALES CALLS	A data broker or list seller bought it from a form, competition, survey or app and resold it.	Sales calls about things you never asked for: energy, insurance, “an accident you had”.	Ask the caller which company they are and where they got your number. Legitimate marketers must say. Then send that company the letter on page 5.
Shared HIDDEN	An app, shop or service passed it to “partners” under a privacy policy you clicked through.	Calls or texts soon after signing up for something.	Think back to what you signed up for just before it started. Send that company the letter on page 5 and ask who received your number.
Posted or public EASY TO FIX	On an old profile, a business listing, a classified ad, a CV site, or a people-search page.	Callers who know your name and town but nothing else.	Search your number in quotes in a search engine and in the social apps you use.

A trick for next time

For new sign-ups, use an email alias or a variation such as yourname+shopname@ (many email services deliver these to your normal inbox). If a scam arrives addressed to that variation, you know which company it came from. It is a strong hint, not proof.

STEP 2 · CUT IT OFF · 15 MINUTES

Cut the calls in the order that works.

Preference lists stop companies that follow the law. Phone settings stop everyone else. Do both.

- [ ] **Turn on spam filtering on your phone** — 2 min
  iPhone: Settings → Apps → Phone → Silence Unknown Callers (on older versions, Settings → Phone). Unknown numbers go to voicemail. **Android:** in the Phone app, Settings → Caller ID & spam, then turn on spam filtering. Wording varies by phone maker.

- [ ] **Add a PIN for SIM swaps and number transfers** — 5 min
  Call your mobile network or use its app and ask for a PIN or password on any SIM change or number transfer. This stops the most damaging use of a leaked number.

- [ ] **Register on the official do-not-call list** UK US — 3 min
  UK: Telephone Preference Service, tpsonline.org.uk, free. **US:** National Do Not Call Registry, donotcall.gov, free. It can take up to a month to take full effect. It stops legitimate sales calls, not scammers or overseas callers. The real services never charge.

- [ ] **Report scam texts by forwarding them** — 1 min
  UK: forward the text to 7726, free on all major networks; forward scam emails to report@phishing.gov.uk. **US:** forward to 7726 (SPAM), then report at reportfraud.ftc.gov.

- [ ] **Hide your number where you posted it** — 5 min
  Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn and others let people find you by your number. Turn off “find me by phone number” and hide it from your profile.

ON THE CALL ITSELF

Don’t

Confirm your name, date of birth or address. Read out a code you were texted. Move money to a “safe account”. Install an app a caller asks for.

Do

Hang up and call back on the number on your card or the company’s website. In the UK, call **159** to reach most major banks safely. Ask a sales caller: “Which company are you, and where did you get my number?”

STEP 3 · KEEP A RECORD

Log the calls. The pattern tells you the source.

Two weeks of notes usually show whether it is one list or many, and which company to ask. It is also the evidence a regulator or your network will want.

DATE	NUMBER	WHO THEY SAID THEY WERE	WHAT THEY KNEW ABOUT ME	PATH GUESS
				stolen · sold · shared · posted
				stolen · sold · shared · posted
				stolen · sold · shared · posted
				stolen · sold · shared · posted
				stolen · sold · shared · posted
				stolen · sold · shared · posted
				stolen · sold · shared · posted
				stolen · sold · shared · posted
				stolen · sold · shared · posted

Lost money or gave details?

Call your bank straight away on the number on your card (UK: 159). Then report it. **UK:** Report Fraud, which replaced Action Fraud, at reportfraud.police.uk or 0300 123 2040 (Scotland: Police Scotland on 101). **US:** reportfraud.ftc.gov, and identitytheft.gov for identity theft.

Got the company's name?

Send it the letter on the next page. You can ask any organisation that holds your data where it came from and who it went to. That turns "how did they get my number?" into a written answer.

STEP 4 · MAKE THEM TELL YOU

The “where did you get my number?” letter.

UK and EU law lets you ask any organisation for a copy of your data, where it came from and who received it. Californians have a similar right to know. Email it to the company’s privacy or data protection contact, from your own email.

Subject: Subject access request: source and recipients of my data

Hello,

I am making a subject access request under Article 15 of the **[UK GDPR / GDPR]**. You contacted me on **[number]** on **[date]**. To find my record, please use: **[name, phone number, email]**.

Please tell me:

1. What personal data you hold about me.
2. Where you obtained it, including the name of any company you got it from.
3. Who you have shared or sold it to, by name where possible.
4. Why you are using it, and how long you will keep it.

I also object to the use of my data for direct marketing under Article 21, and ask you to stop calling and texting me.

I understand you normally have one month to respond, and that a reasonable and proportionate search is expected. If you need more information to find my data, please ask for only what is necessary.

Thank you,
[name] · **[date]**

California: replace the first paragraph with a request to know under the California Consumer Privacy Act, including “the categories of sources and third parties”; businesses normally have 45 days. **Not legal advice.** The UK changed its rules in 2025: searches must be “reasonable and proportionate”, and the deadline can pause while a company asks you to clarify. For official guidance and templates, see ico.org.uk. If you get no answer after the deadline, complain to the company, then to the regulator.

WHAT COMES NEXT

Every answer names someone else. That's where it gets tedious.

The company that called you got your number from a broker. The broker got it from an app. Each answer is a new letter, a new deadline and a new chase. Koverr is being built to run that chain for you: it drafts each request for your approval, tracks the legal clock, reads the replies and follows the trail.

Join the launch list ·koverr.com

Follow the trail

Every company named in a reply becomes the next request.

You approve every request

Nothing is sent in your name without your yes.

Deadlines kept

Reminders at day 31, escalation drafts if they ignore you.

A dated record

Who had your number, who was asked, who answered.

Links and rules checked on 12 November 2026; recheck from February 2027. General information, not legal advice. Koverr is pre-launch and is not affiliated with any service named here. Phone menus vary by model and software version.